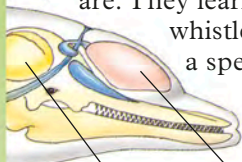




DOLPHINS

Dolphins are small, toothed whales. Some people think that these slim, smooth-skinned mammals are as intelligent as we are. They learn quickly and seem to talk to one another with whistles and clicks. Since ancient times, there has been a special friendship between humans and these playful animals. There are many stories of dolphins saving drowning sailors.



Brain

Melon

Built-in sonar

A dolphin uses sound to find its food and to work out where it is. The melon, a fatty organ in its head, concentrates a stream of clicks which bounce back when they hit something. These echoes tell dolphins where an object is.



Sonar clicks

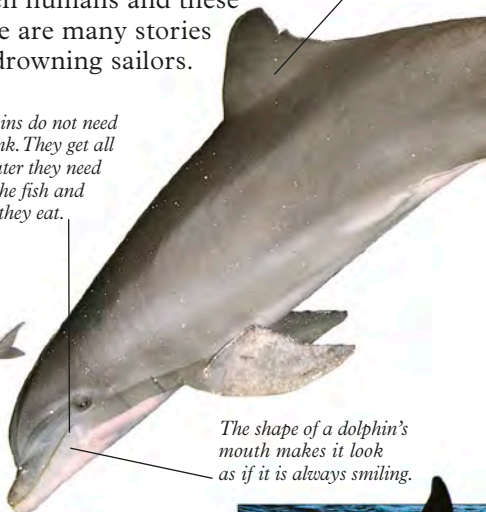


Toothy grin

This bottlenose dolphin has more than 100 pointed teeth, which are about 0.3 inches (eight millimeters) long.

Dolphins do not need to drink. They get all the water they need from the fish and squid they eat.

Large, curved dorsal fin



The shape of a dolphin's mouth makes it look as if it is always smiling.

Hitching a ride

Just in front of a speeding ship there is a wave. Dolphins love to swim in this spot. Like surfers, if they catch the wave in the right way, it will push them through the sea.

Blowhole



Most dolphins have a long snout, called a beak.

